ERA 13

The Spanish-American War & Empire

1898 – 1917

The War of 1898 · an overseas empire · a new world power

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did a 'splendid little war' turn the United States into a global empire?

KEY TERMS

Yellow journalism · the USS Maine · the Treaty of Paris · the Open Door · the Panama Canal · the Roosevelt Corollary

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 7.3 · AMSCO Ch. 7.3

A 'SPLENDID LITTLE WAR'

The War of 1898

The Road to War

REVOLT

Cuba Rebels

Cubans rise against Spanish rule; Americans sympathize.

→

ATROCITY

'Butcher' Weyler

Spain's **reconcentration** camps kill thousands of civilians.

→

HYSTERIA

Yellow Journalism

Hearst and **Pulitzer** sensationalize Spanish cruelty.

→

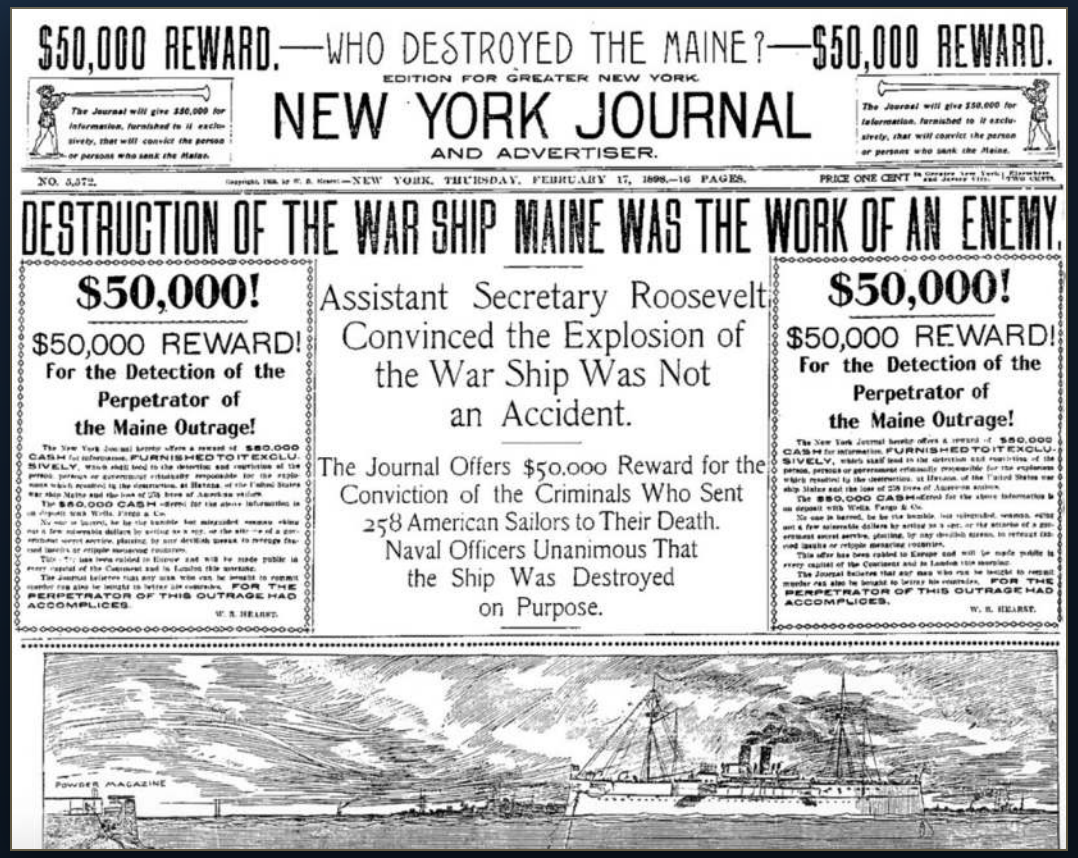
SPARK

The USS Maine

The battleship explodes in Havana Harbor—'Remember the Maine!'

Yellow Journalism

- Rival papers—**Hearst's** *Journal* and **Pulitzer's** *World*—waged a circulation war.
- They exaggerated and invented stories of Spanish atrocities in **Cuba**.
- '**Yellow journalism**' inflamed public demand for war.



$50,000 REWARD.—WHO DESTROYED THE MAINE?—$50,000 REWARD.

EDITION FOR GREATER NEW YORK.

NEW YORK JOURNAL

AND ADVERTISER.

The Journal will give $50,000 for information, furnished to it exclusively, that will convict the person or persons who sank the Maine.

NO. 3,572. NEW YORK, THURSDAY, FEBRUARY 17, 1898.—16 PAGES. PRICE ONE CENT

DESTRUCTION OF THE WAR SHIP MAINE WAS THE WORK OF AN ENEMY.

$50,000!

$50,000 REWARD!

For the Detection of the Perpetrator of the Maine Outrage!

Assistant Secretary Roosevelt Convinced the Explosion of the War Ship Was Not an Accident.

The Journal Offers $50,000 Reward for the Conviction of the Criminals Who Sent 258 American Sailors to Their Death.

Naval Officers Unanimous That the Ship Was Destroyed on Purpose.

$50,000!

$50,000 REWARD!

For the Detection of the Perpetrator of the Maine Outrage!

POWDER MAGAZINE

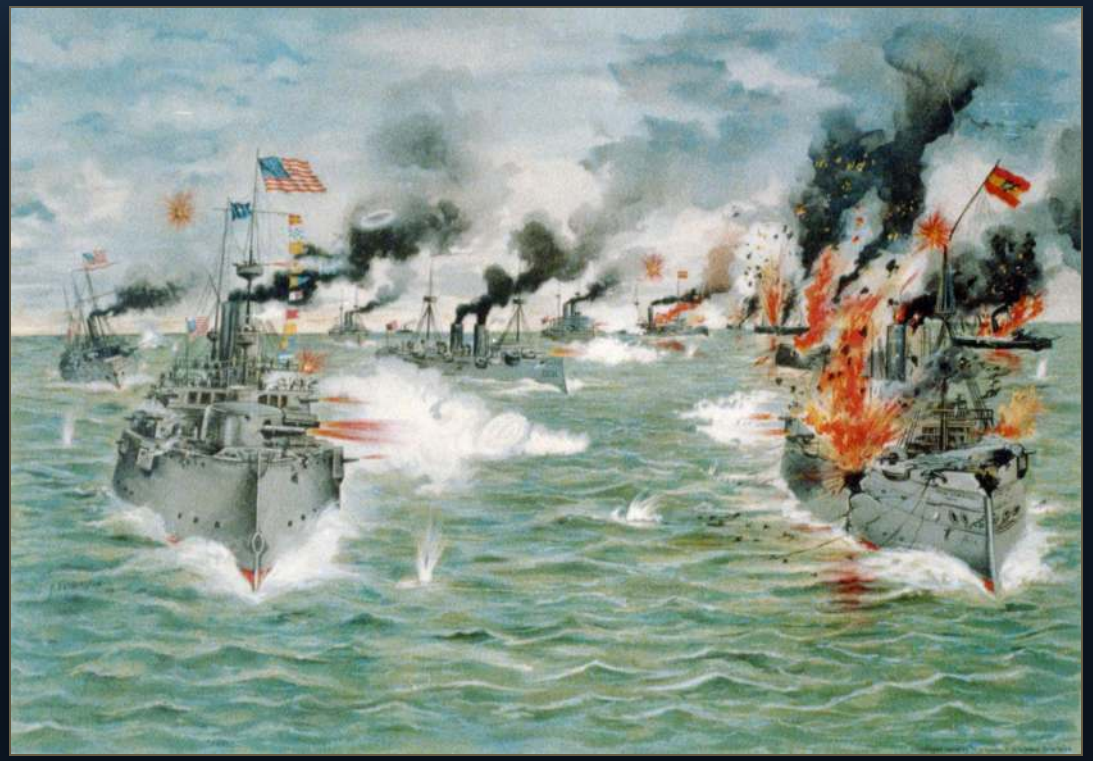
'Remember the Maine!'



- On February 15, 1898, the **USS Maine** exploded in Havana Harbor, killing 260 sailors.
- The cause was likely an accident—but the press blamed Spain.
- '**Remember the Maine! To hell with Spain!**' became the national cry.

A Splendid Little War

- Commodore **George Dewey** destroyed Spain's fleet at **Manila Bay** in the **Philippines**.
- **Theodore Roosevelt**'s **Rough Riders** charged **San Juan Hill** in **Cuba**.
- In just 10 weeks, the U.S. won a lopsided victory.



SECTION

The Fruits of Empire

The Treaty of Paris, 1898

I

Cuba Freed

Spain gives up **Cuba**, which becomes independent—on America's terms.

II

New Territories

The U.S. gains **Puerto Rico** and **Guam** outright.

III

The Philippines

The U.S. buys the **Philippines** for $20 million—sparking fierce debate.

The Question of Cuba

The Teller Amendment

1898 · The promise

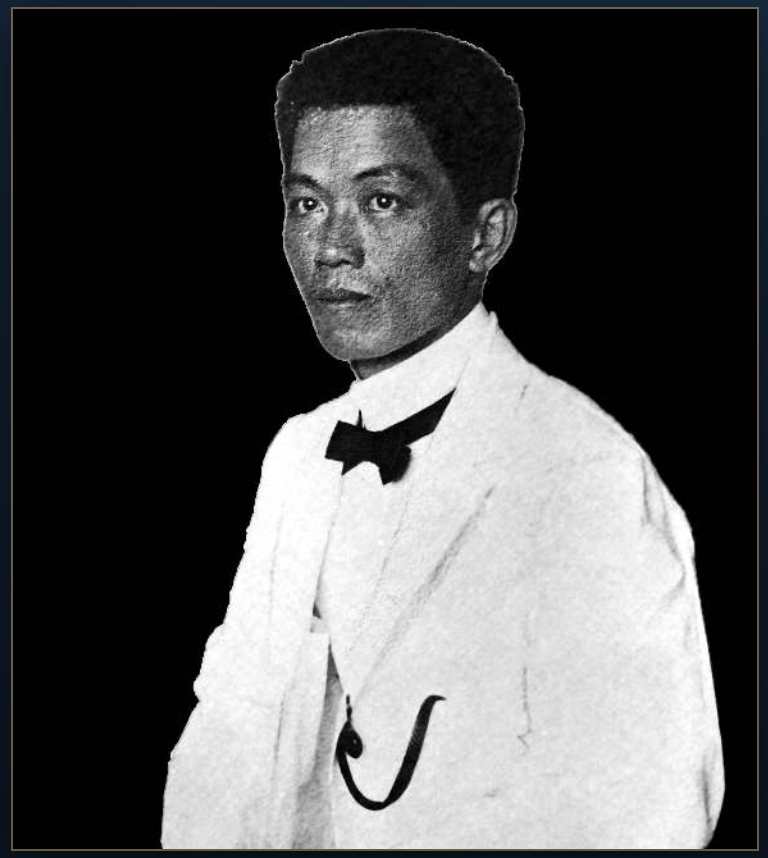
- The U.S. pledged **not to annex Cuba**.
- **Cuba** would win its independence after the war.
- It reassured anti-imperialists at home.

The Platt Amendment

1901 · The reality

- Forced into **Cuba**'s constitution as a condition of U.S. withdrawal.
- Gave the U.S. the right to **intervene** in Cuban affairs.
- Leased **Guantánamo Bay**—making **Cuba** a virtual protectorate.

The Philippine-American War



- Filipinos under **Emilio Aguinaldo** had fought for their own independence.
- When the U.S. annexed the islands instead, they turned their guns on America.
- The brutal war killed ~4,300 U.S. troops and 200,000+ Filipinos.

Governing the New Empire

I

The Insular Cases

The Supreme Court ruled the Constitution did **not fully follow the flag** to new territories.

II

Puerto Rico

The **Foraker** and **Jones Acts** set up civil government and granted U.S. citizenship.

III

A New Status

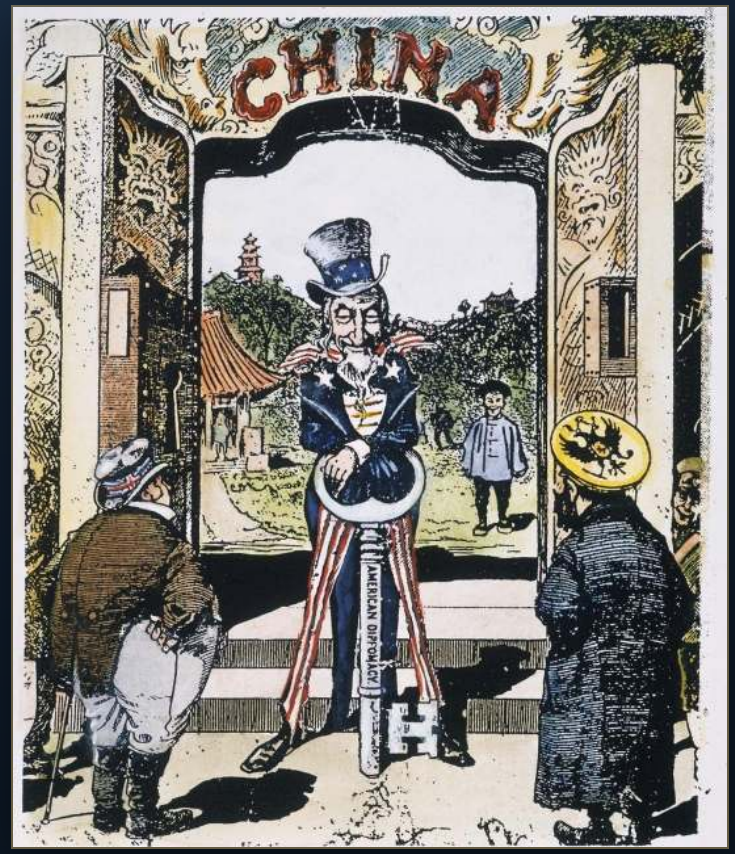
Colonial subjects were neither foreign nations nor full citizens.

SECTION

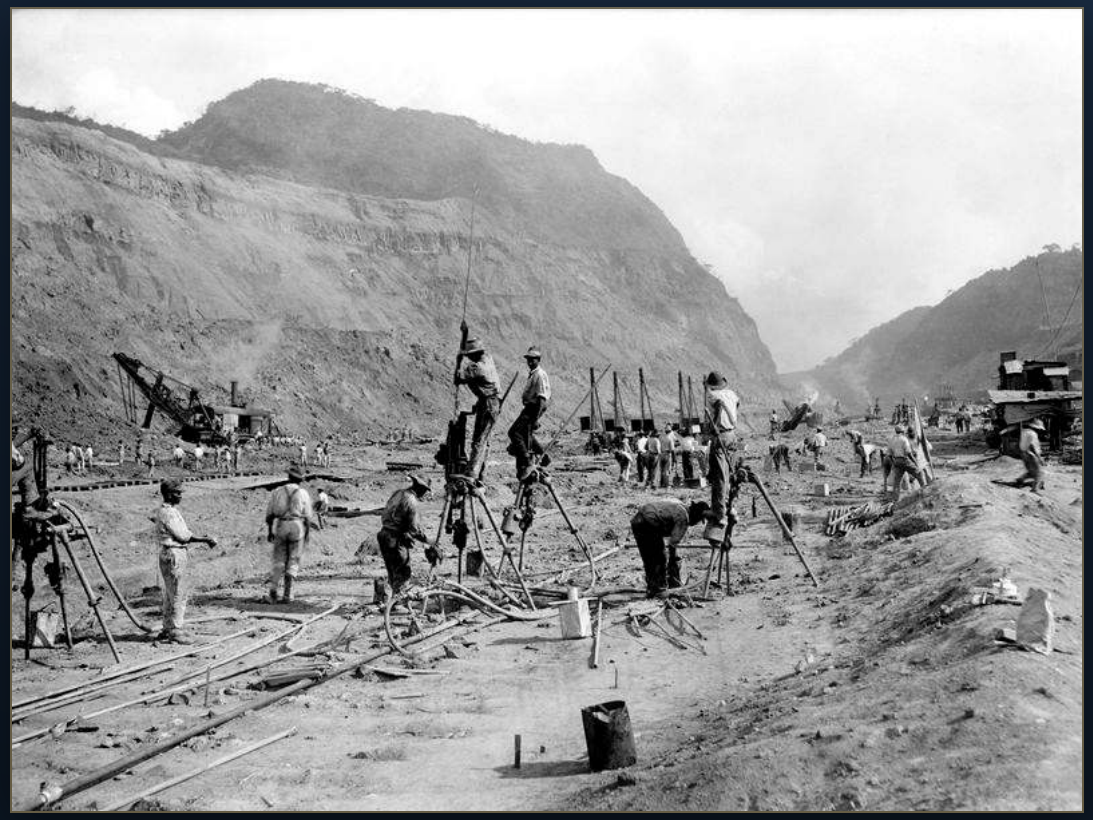
America as a World Power

The Open Door Policy

- Secretary of State **John Hay** demanded equal trading access—an '**Open Door**'—in China.
- When the **Boxer Rebellion** erupted (1900), the U.S. joined an international force to crush it.
- America asserted itself as a Pacific power.



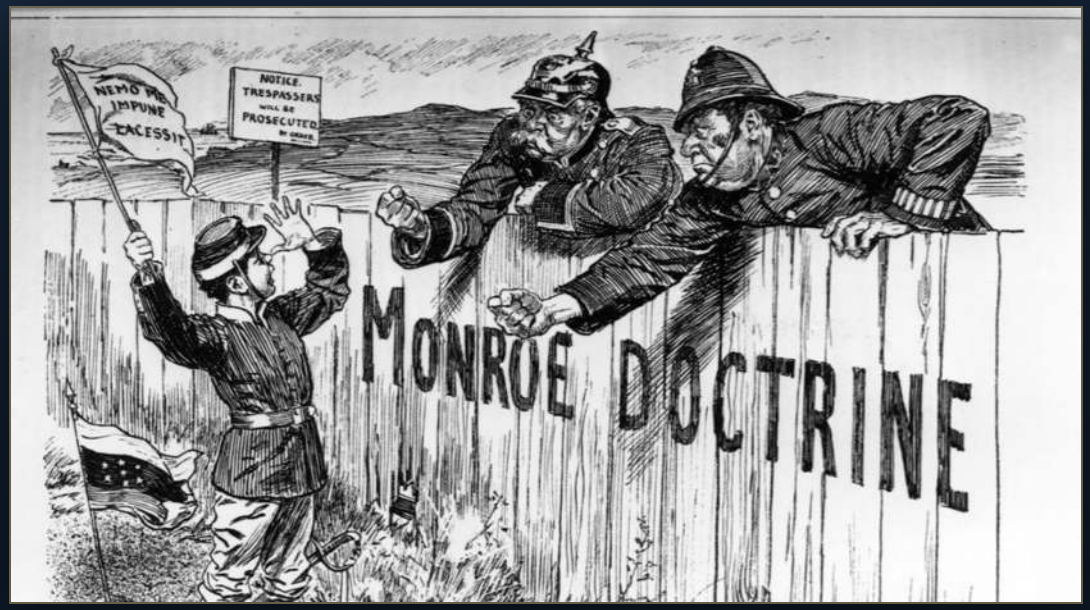
Big Stick & the Panama Canal



- **Theodore Roosevelt** vowed to 'speak softly and carry a **big stick**.'
- He backed Panama's revolt from Colombia to secure a canal zone.
- The **Panama Canal** (1914) linked the Atlantic and Pacific—a strategic prize.

The Roosevelt Corollary

- Roosevelt added a **corollary** to the **Monroe Doctrine**.
- The U.S. claimed the right to act as an '**international police power**' in the Americas.
- It justified repeated U.S. intervention in Latin America.



Diplomacy After Roosevelt

Taft's Dollar Diplomacy

Money over might

- Use American **investment** to extend U.S. influence abroad.
- 'Substituting dollars for bullets.'
- Deepened economic ties—and resentment—in Latin America.

Wilson's Moral Diplomacy

Principle over profit

- Promote **democracy** and oppose imperialism—in theory.
- In practice, Wilson intervened repeatedly (Mexico, the Caribbean).
- Chased Pancho Villa into Mexico with U.S. troops.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Spanish-American War & Empire

1. **Yellow journalism** and the **USS Maine** pushed the U.S. into a swift war that freed **Cuba** and won an empire.

2. The **Treaty of Paris** gave America **Puerto Rico**, **Guam**, **and the Philippines**—igniting a brutal **Philippine-American War** and a debate over rights in the territories.

3. As a new world power, the U.S. pursued the **Open Door**, built the **Panama Canal**, and asserted the **Roosevelt Corollary**—through **Big Stick**, dollar, and **moral diplomacy**.

DISCUSS & APPLY

The Spanish-American War & Empire

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain how **yellow journalism** and the **USS Maine** pushed the U.S. into war with Spain.

CONTEXTUALIZATION

How did the **Philippine-American War** expose the contradictions of American imperialism?

COMPARISON

Compare **Big Stick, dollar, and moral diplomacy**. How did each project American power?

Up next — **Lesson 33: The Progressive Era** (reforming an industrial nation)